

## DigiPick of the month



### WIN!

A Mini Keypad by Travel Pac just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should be shot by you, and should not have been published earlier. Send your picture to [digipick@thinkdigit.com](mailto:digipick@thinkdigit.com). The prize-winning picture will be published each month.

So, are the sneakers free with the computers, or is it the other way around?

This month's winner is Vikram Bothe from Pune. He wins an

**NBA LIVE 2004**  
worth **Rs.1,299/-**

from Gayatri Impex Pvt. Ltd.

Express your game with new freestyle shooting, signature moves, mid-air shot adjustments, and more.



of those that were closed most recently broke rules that limit how close they can be to schools: they need to be at least 200 metres away.

China seems obsessed with the so-called moral issues related to Internet usage, a culture breakdown among the youth stemming from the use of the Internet and playing violent video games, and so on. For example, the recent shutdowns are the latest in a series of steps the government has taken to crack down on "immoral Net use."

All the one lakh or so cyber-café in China are required to use software that controls what Web sites users can view.

The government also keeps logs of all the sites that its people visit. The 'Reporters Without Borders' group said in a report that the technologies that the Chinese government uses to intercept e-mail and to censor the Internet usage of its citizens, are amongst the most highly developed in the world. Big Brother really does watch you when you are in China!

### ABSTRACT AND DYNAMIC

## Modern Art On Ancient Machines

Apple's ancient, easy-to-use programming tool, HyperCard, has found an afterlife—at the cutting edge of European modern art. British artist Richard Bolam uses HyperCard to create generative art using ancient Mac classics. Bolam, who lives and works in Sheffield, England, is gaining recognition as an artist successfully working with technology.

What's interesting here is that he doesn't use the latest technology; quite the contrary, he uses the relatively ancient technology embodied in the HyperCard software and old Macintoshes.

"I enjoy embracing the technology of old Macs," Bolam said.

A recent work, *Hyperscape 1*, was shown at Sweden's Malmö Konsthall as part of the Electrohype festival. *Hyperscape 1* is a generative art installation

that runs on eight compact Macs. One Mac runs a program that Bolam wrote in HyperCard.

The HyperCard program determines the screen output on the other seven machines. All the screens start out blank, and steadily fill with semi-random shapes and images. The master Mac running HyperCard proposes certain image manipulations—inverting areas of the screen, tracing edges or copying parts of images—and the other machines decide whether or not to accept the changes.

The result is abstract, random and dynamic—an ever-changing montage of broken and distorted shapes spread across the eight screens.

Bolam said the idea is to illustrate how humans process information. "If you put a series of objects in a line, your brain looks for similarities as they've been queued," said Bolam.

"It is obviously organised. *Hyperscape 1* is just the opposite: because the screens are all similar, the brain looks for differences," added Bolam.

## People Who Changed Computing

### The Wizard Behind Windows

One of the most important people in Microsoft's history, David Weise, was one of the developers responsible for a technical breakthrough that brought about the success of Windows.

After leaving Princeton with a PhD in molecular biophysics, Weise and a few

others founded Dynamical Systems Research (DSR) to create a clone of Topview, IBM's text-based multi-tasking shell that was supposed to revolutionise the PC industry. It was an utter flop.



David Weise

Microsoft was looking at integrating Topview support into Windows. In 1986, Microsoft acquired DSR and hired Weise. Just two years later, Microsoft was planning to abandon Windows and move to IBM's OS/2. However, Weise figured out how to get Windows to run on the 80286 in 'Protected Mode'. Thanks to this breakthrough, Microsoft out-marketed IBM. Weise is credited with almost single-handedly making Windows a viable product—Windows 3.0, soon after its release, was the most successful software project in history, selling more than 10 million copies a month.

Weise was made a 'Microsoft Distinguished Engineer' in 2002, a title that marks the pinnacle of a developer's career at Microsoft. He quit Microsoft in February, and now intends to pursue molecular biology.